



Calling it a day: Rani Rampal, who debuted as a 14-year-old at the 2008 Olympic Qualifiers in Kazan, announced her retirement on October 24, 2024, at a felicitation in New Delhi, concluding a remarkable 14-year career as the undisputed queen of Indian women's hockey. RITU RAJ KONWAR

However, ahead of the Asian Champions Trophy in November, Harendra promised fans that they would witness a "new side of Indian women's hockey."

True to his word, the team rose to the occasion, delivering an impressive performance by scoring 27 goals in a seven-match unbeaten

run to retain the title.

Deepika Kumari topped the scoring charts with 11 goals, including the decisive strike in the final against China, and was deservedly named Player of the Tournament.

Meanwhile, just over a month after its Olympic success, the Indian